

UltraGroth. Lookup Checks Enabled in Groth16

September 4, 2025

Distributed Lab

 zkdl-camp.github.io

 github.com/ZKDL-Camp



Introduction

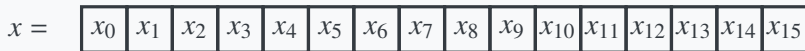
Motivation

We typically want to check **inclusion** $\{z_i\}_{i \in [n]} \subseteq \{t_j\}_{j \in [v]}$, where $\{z_i\}_{i \in [n]}$ is part of the witness while $\{t_j\}_{j \in [v]}$ is the lookup table.

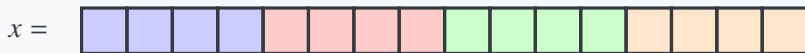
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Example usage: effective range-checks (Bionetta, Rarimo circuits, non-native ZK verifications etc.)



16 constraints



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x_1

x_2

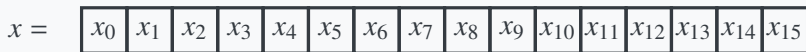
x_3

4 constraints + one-time 2^4 commitment

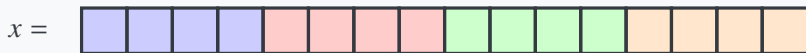
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Generally: for n -bit range-check, the circuit's complexity reduces from $O(n)$ to $O(2^w + \frac{n}{w})$, which yields $O(n/\log n)$ asymptotic.

Logup Check

Theorem (Some stuff from ZKDL Camp)

The inclusion check $\{z_i\}_{i \in [n]} \subseteq \{t_i\}_{i \in [v]}$ is satisfied if and only if there exists the set of multiplicities $\{\mu_i\}_{i \in [v]}$ where $\mu_i = \#\{j \in [n] : z_j = t_i\}$ such that for $\gamma \leftarrow \$ \mathbb{F}$:

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Problem: We cannot define random signals in Circom since Groth16, compared to $\mathcal{P}lonK$ or sumcheck-based approaches, is not compiled from interactive protocol using Fiat-Shamir heuristic.

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We can instead apply the **Freiveld's protocol**. Sample random $\gamma \leftarrow \$ \mathbb{F}^n$, compute C off-circuit and then verify:

$$AB\gamma = C\gamma \quad // \text{ Costs } 3n^2 \text{ constraints}$$

Example: Attention layer implementation in zkML.

Plan

1. We recap the Groth16 construction.
2. We identify how to make it interactive.
3. We specify how Fiat-Shamir transformation should be applied.
4. We show how it can be practically implemented.

Groth16 Recap

R1CS

Recall that we can encode any NP statement in the form of m equations of form $\langle \ell_j, \mathbf{z} \rangle \cdot \langle \mathbf{r}_j, \mathbf{z} \rangle = \langle \mathbf{o}_j, \mathbf{z} \rangle$ for $j \in [m]$ and $\mathbf{z} \in \mathbb{F}^n$. Such way of representing the statement is called **R1CS arithmetization**.

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- ✓ As of now, this is one of the most optimal arithmetization systems available (compared to PlonK and AIR).
- ✓ All linear operations over elements of $\mathbf{z}$ cost **0 constraints**, compared to PlonK.

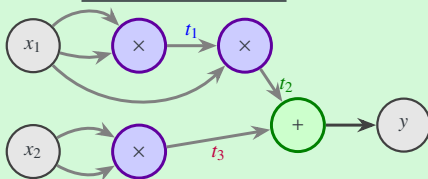
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Circuit Diagram



Constraints

$$t_1 = x_1 \cdot x_1$$

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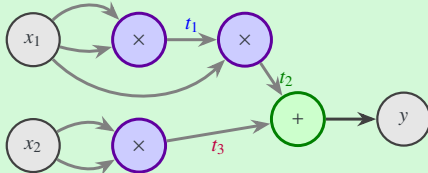
$$t_3 = x_2 \cdot x_2$$

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In this case, the witness looks as $z = (1, x_1, x_2, t_1, t_2, t_3, y)$, and (for simplicity, consider only L, R):

$$L = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad R = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

QAP

We interpolate the columns of each of the matrices, thus getting $3n$ polynomials $\{(\ell_i(X), r_i(X), o_i(X))\}_{i \in [n]} \subseteq \mathbb{F}^{\leq m}[X]$:

$$\ell_i(\omega^j) = L_{i,j}, \quad r_i(\omega^j) = R_{i,j}, \quad o_i(\omega^j) = O_{i,j}, \quad i \in [n], j \in [m]$$

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$$\sum_{i \in [n]} z_i \ell_i(X) \cdot \sum_{i \in [n]} z_i r_i(X) = \sum_{i \in [n]} z_i o_i(X) + t_\Omega(X) h(X),$$

where $h(X)$ is computed by a prover and $t_\Omega(X) \triangleq \prod_{h \in \Omega} (X - h)$ is the *vanishing polynomial over evaluation domain* $\Omega = \{\omega^j\}_{j \in [m]}$. The corresponding relation:

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$$\mathcal{R}_{\text{QAP}} = \left\{ \begin{array}{l} \mathbb{X} = \{z_i\}_{i \in I_X} \\ \mathbb{W} = \{z_i\}_{i \in I_W} \end{array} \middle| \begin{array}{l} \sum_{i \in [n]} z_i \ell_i(X) \cdot \sum_{i \in [n]} z_i r_i(X) = \sum_{i \in [n]} z_i o_i(X) + t_\Omega(X) h(X) \\ \text{for some } h(X) \in \mathbb{F}[X] \end{array} \right\}$$

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- $\text{Verify}(\sigma, \mathbb{x}, \pi) \rightarrow \{0, 1\}$. The verifier gets the arithmetic circuit $t : \mathbb{F}^{m+k} \rightarrow \mathbb{F}^n$ of degree d and verifies whether $t(\sigma, \pi) = 0$.

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Groth16 is essentially a Linear NIP where $d = 2$ and σ is given by:

$$\sigma = \left(a, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \{t^i\}_{i \in [n]}, \left\{ \frac{\zeta_i(\tau)}{\gamma} \right\}_{i \in [m]}, \left\{ \frac{\tau^i t_{\Omega}(\tau)}{\delta} \right\}_{i \in [n]} \right),$$

with $\zeta_i(X) := \beta l_i(X) + a r_i(X) + o_i(X)$ and $\tau = (a, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \tau)$.

Groth16 Construction

Fix bilinear group $\mathcal{G} = (\mathbb{G}_1, \mathbb{G}_2, \mathbb{G}_T, e)$ with pairing $e : \mathbb{G}_1 \times \mathbb{G}_2 \rightarrow \mathbb{G}_T$.

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$$a(X) = a + \sum_{i \in [n]} z_i \ell_i(X) + r\delta, \quad b(X) = \beta + \sum_{i \in [n]} z_i r_i(X) + s\delta,$$

$$c(X) = \delta^{-1} \left(\sum_{i \in \mathcal{I}_W} z_i \zeta_i(X) + h(X) t_\Omega(X) \right) + a(X)s + b(X)r - rs\delta$$

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- $\text{Verify}(\text{vp}, \mathbb{X}, \pi) \rightarrow \{0, 1\}$. Parse $\pi = (\pi_A, \pi_C, \pi_B)$ and accept the proof if and only if

$$e(\pi_A, \pi_B) = e(g_1^a, g_2^\beta) \cdot e(g_1^{i(\tau)}, g_2^\gamma) \cdot e(\pi_C, g_2^\delta),$$

where $i(X) := \gamma^{-1} \sum_{i \in I_X} z_i \zeta_i(X)$ is the input commitment.

UltraGroth

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Problem. We cannot practically “hash” the witness part $\mathbb{w}_0$.

2-round UltraGroth Construction

Split public indexing set $\mathcal{I}_X$ into two parts: $\mathcal{I}_X^{\langle 0 \rangle}$ and $\mathcal{I}_X^{\langle 1 \rangle}$. Similarly, split the witness indexing set $\mathcal{I}_W$ into $\mathcal{I}_W^{\langle 0 \rangle}$ and $\mathcal{I}_W^{\langle 1 \rangle}$.

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Round 1: $\mathcal{P}$ samples the challenge $\mathbb{x}_1 \leftarrow \mathcal{H}(\sigma, \pi_C^{(0)})$, samples $r, s \leftarrow \$ \mathbb{F}$ and computes $\pi_C^{(1)} \leftarrow g_1^{c_1(\tau)}$ as:

$$c_1(X) = \delta^{-1} \left(\sum_{j \in \mathcal{I}_W^{(1)}} z_j \zeta_j(X) + h(X) t_\Omega(X) \right) + a(X)s + b(X)r - r_0 \delta_0 - rs \delta$$

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Then, parts $\pi_A \leftarrow g_1^{a(\tau)}$ and $\pi_B \leftarrow g_1^{b(\tau)}$ are computed as usual via:

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Note: $\delta_0 c_0(X) + \delta c_1(X)$ is exactly $\delta c(X)$ is the original Groth16.

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Thus, $\mathcal{V}$ checks:

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Conclusion

UltraGroth protocol's verifier is only **4 pairings**, **1 hashing operation**, and $O(|\mathbb{x}|)$ exponentiations over $\mathbb{G}_1$.

Multi-round UltraGroth

Definition (dQAP)

We define the $(d + 1)$ -round quadratic arithmetic program (or **dQAP**, for short), as follows:

$$\mathcal{R}_{\text{dQAP}} = \left\{ \begin{array}{l} \mathbb{X}_i = \{z_j\}_{j \in \mathcal{I}_X^{(i)}} \\ \mathbb{W}_i = \{z_j\}_{j \in \mathcal{I}_W^{(i)}} \\ \text{for } i \in [d + 1] \end{array} \left| \begin{array}{l} \ell(X) \cdot r(X) = o(X) + t_\Omega(X)h(X) \\ \ell(X) = \sum_{i \in [n]} z_i \ell_i(X), \\ r(X) = \sum_{i \in [n]} z_i r_i(X), \\ o(X) = \sum_{i \in [n]} z_i o_i(X), \\ \text{for some } h(X) \in \mathbb{F}[X] \end{array} \right. \right\},$$

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Define **strategy** for $\mathcal{R}_{\text{dQAP}}$ as the collection of functions $S = \{S_i\}_{i \in [d]}$ each of which computes the witness for the given round given previous witnesses and challenges and the current challenge, sampled by the verifier. In other words,

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0QAP represents the regular QAP with the strategy $S = \{S_0\}$ that consists of the witness generator: $\mathbb{w} = S_0(\mathbb{x})$. In turn, 1QAP represents the lookup Groth16 version where $\mathbb{w}_0 = S_0(\mathbb{x}_0)$ computes the witness without lookups while $\mathbb{w}_1 = S_1(\mathbb{x}_0, \mathbb{x}_1, \mathbb{w}_0)$ computes lookup constraints.

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- If $i < d$, for each $j \in I_X^{(i+1)}$, set $z_j \leftarrow \mathcal{H}(a_{i+1}, g_1^j)$.

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Verification: $e(\pi_A, \pi_B) = e(g_1^a, g_2^\beta) \cdot e(g_1^{i(\tau)}, g_2^y) \cdot \prod_{i \in [d+1]} e(\pi_C^{\langle i \rangle}, g_2^{\delta_i})$.

UltraGroth Efficiency

Groth16 performance over the circuit of size n and statement size ℓ .

- **Prover work:** MSM of size $O(n)$ over $\mathbb{G}_1$ and $\mathbb{G}_2$.
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UltraGroth performance over $\mathcal{R}_{\text{dQAP}}$ in turn:

- **Prover work:** MSM of size $O(n/\log n)$ over $\mathbb{G}_1$ and $\mathbb{G}_2$.
- **Proof size:** $(d + 2)\mathbb{G}_1 + \mathbb{G}_2$.
- **Verifier work:** $(d + 3)$ pairings + $O(\ell)$ $\mathbb{G}_1$ exps + $\sum_{i \in [d+1] \setminus \{0\}} |\mathbb{X}_i|$ hashing operations.
- Allowed interactivenss for potentially more complex protocols.

Any Questions?



zkdl-camp.github.io



github.com/ZKDL-Camp

